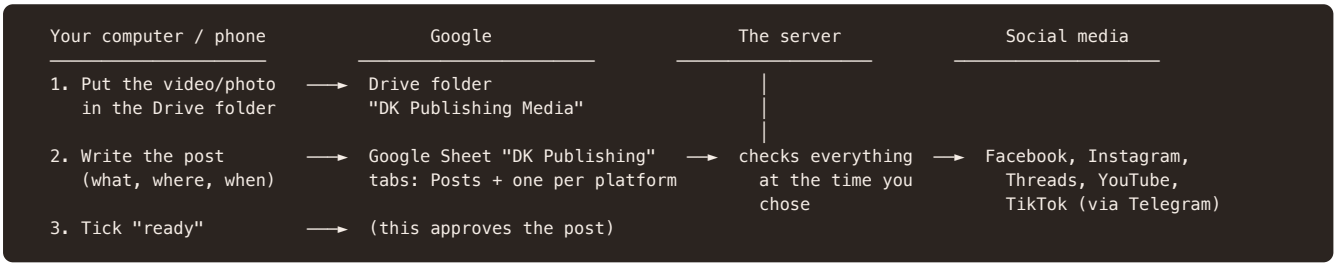
How to schedule a post with the Google Sheet and Drive

For: anyone on the team who wants to publish. No technical knowledge needed. Time: about 3 minutes per post.

The idea in one picture



You only touch the **Drive folder** and the **Sheet**. The server does the rest, at the minute you chose. It never posts the same thing twice.

Before you start (one time)

- You can open the Google Sheet **DK Publishing** and the Drive folder **DK Publishing Media**.
- Grey columns in the Sheet are filled in by the system. **Never type in grey columns.**
- **Never rename a column header.** (You may move columns around, and add your own columns on the far right.)

Step 1: Put the file in Drive

1. Open the Drive folder **DK Publishing Media**.
2. Drag your video or photo in. Wait until the upload finishes.
3. Remember the **exact file name**, for example `eid_platter.mp4`.

Do	Don't
Use simple names: `eid_platter.mp4`, `04_01.jpg`	Two files with the same name in the folder (the Sheet will refuse it)
Keep the name exactly the same in the Sheet (capital letters and `.mp4` count)	Rename the file after you approved the post
One file per name, replace nothing in place	Replace a file while a post using it is waiting (the post is withdrawn and has to be approved again)

Which files each platform takes

Platform	Format in the Sheet	Files
Instagram	`feed`	1 photo, **JPEG only**
Instagram	`carousel`	2 to 10 JPEG photos (the order you write them is the swipe order)
Instagram	`reel`	1 video (`.mp4` , `.mov`), vertical 9:16 works best
Instagram	`story`	1 photo or video, **no caption**
Facebook	`post`	no file, text only
Facebook	`photo`	1 to 10 photos (`.jpg` , `.png`), several = one album
Facebook	`video`	1 video, up to 1 GB
Threads	`text` / `image` / `video`	none / 1 photo / 1 video
YouTube	`video`	1 video
TikTok	(video)	1 video

The dropdowns also list Facebook `reel` and Threads `carousel` . They are **not supported yet**: pick Facebook `video` or Threads `image` .

Step 2: Write the post on the Posts tab

One row = one idea. Fill in these cells:

Column	What to write	Example
`post_key`	A **unique** name. Never reused, never changed later.	`DK-2610-80`
`title`	Only for you. Never published.	`Eid platter reel`
`media`	File name(s) from Drive, separated by commas	`eid_platter.mp4`
`default_caption`	The text used by every platform that has an empty caption	`Slow-cooked for Eid. Order for Saturday!` 🪔
`default_slot`	When to publish, **Berlin time**, as a real date-time	`14.11.2026 18:00`
`ready`	**Leave it unticked for now**	☐

Carousel example for `media` : `04_01.jpg, 04_02.jpg, 04_03.jpg` .

Step 3: Say where it goes: one row per platform

Open the tab of each platform you want (**Facebook**, **Instagram**, **Threads**, **YouTube**, **TikTok**). Add one row per post. The columns on every platform tab:

Column	What to do
`post_key`	Pick the same key from the dropdown
`enabled`	**Tick it.** Untick later to cancel

Column	What to do
`account`	Pick the account from the dropdown
`caption`	Leave **empty** to use the default caption from Posts
`slot`	Leave **empty** to use the default slot. Fill it to post at a different time on this platform

Then fill the platform's own columns:

Instagram reel `format` = `reel`, `share_to_feed` = ☑ (also shows on your profile grid)

Instagram carousel `format` = `carousel` (media needs 2 to 10 photos)

Facebook video `format` = `video`

YouTube (all three are needed) `title` = `Dum biryani in 40 seconds`, `made_for_kids` = `no`, optionally `description`, `tags`, `visibility_after_publish`

TikTok `privacy_level` = `public` (you must choose it every time)

Threads `format` = `image` (or `text` / `video`)

Reddit (not connected yet; the tab exists for later) `subreddit`, `title`, `post_type` are required

> **Extra:** `delivery` (Facebook video, YouTube). Empty means `direct`: the server publishes at the minute you chose. `native` means Facebook/YouTube hold the post and publish it themselves (works even if our server is off). `native` needs the slot to be **at least 10 minutes ahead**.

Worked example: one reel to three platforms at different times

Posts tab

post_key	title	media	default_caption	default_slot	ready
DK-2610-80	Eid platter reel	eid_platter.mp4	Slow-cooked for Eid. Order for Saturday! 🍛	14.11.2026 18:00	☐

Instagram tab

post_key	enabled	account	caption	slot	format	share_to_feed
DK-2610-80	☑	Dhaka Kacchi	*(empty)*	*(empty)*	reel	☑

YouTube tab

post_key	enabled	account	caption	slot	title	made_for_kids
DK-2610-80	☑	Dhaka Kacchi	*(empty)*	14.11.2026 19:30	Dum biryani in 40 seconds	no

TikTok tab

post_key	enabled	account	caption	slot	privacy_level
DK-2610-80	☑	Dhaka Kacchi	*(empty)*	*(empty)*	public

Result: Instagram and TikTok at 18:00, YouTube at 19:30, all with the same caption (YouTube uses the title instead of a caption).

Step 4: Approve

Tick **`ready`** on the Posts row. That is your approval for every platform you enabled.

Within about **2 minutes** the `status` column on each platform row changes. Nothing is published until the slot.

Step 5: Watch the status

status	Meaning	What to do
(empty)	Not approved yet (`ready` not ticked)	Tick `ready` when it is right
`draft`	Saved but not approved yet (for example `ready` is not ticked, or the row has a problem)	Check `last_error`, then tick `ready`
`invalid`	Something is wrong. **`last_error` says what, in plain words**	Fix it, the Sheet re-checks automatically
`approved` / `preparing` / `prepared`	Accepted and waiting for its time	Nothing
`scheduling_native`	Being handed to Facebook/YouTube to hold for you (a few seconds)	Nothing
`scheduled_native`	Facebook/YouTube is holding it for you	Nothing
`publishing`	Going out right now	Nothing
`published`	Live. **`live_url`** has the link	Done 🎉
`sent to you`	TikTok: a card with the video was sent to you on **Telegram**	Post it by hand from Telegram
`unknown`	The server could not tell whether it went out and is checking with the platform	**Wait. Never create the post again** (that could post twice). It becomes `published` or `failed`
`failed` / `expired`	It did not go out. `last_error` says why	Fix and ask for help if unclear
`cancelled`	Cancelled by you	-

The **Posts** tab shows a summary like `2 of 3 live, 1 failed`.

Changing or cancelling a post

I want to	Do this
Fix a typo **before** it is live	Edit the caption/slot in the row. It is withdrawn and approved again automatically (if `ready` is still ticked)
Cancel one platform	Untick `enabled` on that platform's row
Cancel everything	Untick `enabled` on every row of that post
Bring a cancelled post back	Tick `enabled` again (or put the row back)

I want to	Do this
Change a post that is already live	Not possible here. Edit it on the platform itself. Edits in the Sheet are ignored once it is live

> **Safety brake.** If one sync would cancel **more than 5 scheduled posts at once** (for example because rows were deleted by accident), nothing is changed and you get a Telegram alert. Restore the rows or ask the developer to confirm.

Posts that come from software (the Calendar tab)

Other programs or AI agents can also submit posts (see guide 02). They **never appear in the Posts or platform tabs**. They wait for you in the **Calendar** tab:

1. Open **Calendar**. Every post of every platform is there, **sorted by date**.
2. The `source` column says `human` (typed here) or `agent` (from software), and `by` says which software.
3. Posts from software that wait for you show `awaiting_approval`, with the caption, the files and a `note`.
4. Scroll to the far right: tick **`approve`** to schedule it, or **`reject`** to cancel it.
5. Within about 2 minutes the row updates (an approved post gets its normal status, a rejected one disappears).

Only `awaiting_approval` rows react to ticks. Do not edit grey cells.

The most common mistakes

Mistake	What you see	Fix
File name differs from Drive (`Eid_Platter.mp4` vs `eid_platter.mp4`)	`invalid`: "Media file ... was not found in the Drive folder"	Copy the exact name
Slot typed as plain text (`14/11 18h`)	`invalid`: slot must be a real date-time	Type `14.11.2026 18:00` so Google shows it as a date
Slot in the past	`invalid`	Pick a future time
Time on the clock-change night (the hour that does not exist or happens twice)	`invalid`	Pick another time
Forgot to tick `enabled`	Nothing happens for that platform	Tick it
Forgot `ready`	Everything stays empty	Tick `ready` on Posts
Two Posts rows with the same `post_key`	"appears more than once"	Keep one, give the other a new key
YouTube without `made_for_kids` or `title`	`invalid`	Fill both
TikTok without `privacy_level`	`invalid`	Choose one
Caption too long (Instagram 2,200 / Threads 500 characters)	`invalid`: shows the limit	Shorten it
Instagram feed with a PNG	`invalid`: JPEG only	Export as JPG

Mistake	What you see	Fix
Instagram story with a caption	Nothing is wrong, but the caption is **not shown**	Stories carry no caption on Instagram; put the text in the image
Facebook `reel` or Threads `carousel`	`invalid`: "not supported yet"	Use Facebook `video`, or Threads `image`
Renamed a column header	Warning: "tab is missing column ..." and the tab is skipped	Restore the exact header name

Quick checklist (copy for every post)

- [ ] File is in the Drive folder and the name is spelled exactly.
- [ ] Posts row: unique `post_key`, `media`, `default_caption`, `default_slot` (a real date-time, in the future).
- [ ] One row per platform: `enabled` ☑, `account` chosen, platform columns filled.
- [ ] Ticked **`ready`**.
- [ ] After 2 minutes: no `invalid`. Check `last_error` if there is.
- [ ] At the slot: `published` and a `live_url` (TikTok: a Telegram card).